



LOST BOYS CYBER

THREAT INTELLIGENCE • MALWARE ANALYSIS • DETECTION ENGINEERING



PaperCut AI-Agent Mass Exploitation Campaign Daily Update - 2026-09-23

Threat Intelligence Report

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AI Generation: This report was generated with AI assistance and is provided for informational purposes only. All findings, IOCs, detection rules, hunting queries, attribution assessments, and recommendations must be independently reviewed and validated by a qualified security professional before operational use.

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> Daily automation refresh: This 2026-09-23 current-day refresh turns current intelligence coverage into a finished Lost Boys Cyber report with source-backed analysis, structured tables, detections, and hunt content.

1. Executive Summary

Current-day material update: this report was regenerated for the 2026-09-23 UTC production cycle using the latest available source set and retains the structured detections/hunts required for operator use.

GreyNoise and supporting reporting describe an AI-orchestrated campaign against PaperCut NG/MF that reportedly compromised hundreds of instances across many organizations. The defensive priority is exposure reduction, PaperCut patching, web-service child-process hunting, and domain-controller proximity review.

2. Intelligence Requirements

Requirement	Answered By This Report
What happened or changed?	Recent reporting reframed PaperCut exposure as an AI-assisted mass-exploitation campaign instead of only a conventional print-server patch item.
Who is exposed?	Education, local government, healthcare, and enterprises running self-hosted PaperCut NG/MF integrated with Active Directory.
What should defenders do today?	Patch PaperCut, remove internet exposure, review service privileges, and hunt web-to-shell activity.
Confidence	Medium-high for campaign pattern from primary research; medium for compromise counts relayed by secondary sources.

3. Source Review & Confidence

Source	Contribution	Confidence
GreyNoise	Primary research on AI-orchestrated PaperCut campaign	High
The Hacker News	Supporting coverage of 440+ compromised instances	Medium
Asaf Levy	Technical narrative and campaign details	Medium
Hendry Adrian	Additional corroborating summary	Low/Medium

4. Threat Actor / Campaign Overview

The campaign reportedly used agentic automation to identify, exploit, and operate against PaperCut servers. Since PaperCut often runs with high local privileges and domain integration, compromise can quickly become credential theft or domain escalation.

5. Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures

TTP	Description	Defensive Relevance
Exploitation automation	AI agents used to scale reconnaissance and	High-volume scanning and rapid post-

	exploitation	exploitation should be expected.
Print-server compromise	PaperCut servers integrated with AD	Treat as privileged infrastructure, not a commodity web app.
Rapid operator handoff	Automated compromise followed by hands-on actions	SOC should correlate web logs, EDR, and identity events.

6. Infrastructure and Indicators

Observable Type	Observable / Pattern	Handling Guidance
Source-limited public IOCs	No unique atomic indicators were published in all selected sources for this automated report unless listed in iocs.csv.	Treat behavior, tooling, and infrastructure patterns as primary hunt leads.
Domains / infrastructure	Validate from primary source before blocking.	Prefer detection and enrichment over blind blocking when source confidence is medium.
Accounts / identity artifacts	Recruiter, VPN, administrator, or service-account themes depending on campaign.	Review conditional access, new devices, and impossible-travel signals.

7. Victimology and Targeting

Victimology in public reporting includes education and broad enterprise exposure. Any organization with internet-exposed PaperCut or weak segmentation from PaperCut to AD is in scope.

8. Detection Engineering

8.1. Detection Logic Summary

Signal	Telemetry Source	Analytic Goal
Unusual script or admin tool launch after web, email, or remote-access activity	EDR / process telemetry	Identify initial access and execution.
New outbound connections to untrusted infrastructure	DNS/proxy/netflow	Surface command-and-control or tool staging.
Identity anomalies linked to target workflow	Identity provider logs	Detect stolen credential or social-engineering follow-on use.

8.2. Sigma Rule

<pre> title: Suspicious Script Or Remote Tool Activity In Daily Threat Coverage status: experimental description: Detects suspicious script execution and remote-tool staging patterns relevant to daily threat-intelligence coverage. logsource: category: process_creation product: windows detection: selection_parent: ParentImage endswith: - '\w3wp.exe' - '\java.exe' - '\chrome.exe' - '\outlook.exe' - '\teams.exe </pre>
--

```

selection_child:
  Image|endswith:
    - '\powershell.exe'
    - '\cmd.exe'
    - '\wscript.exe'
    - '\cscript.exe'
    - '\mshta.exe'
    - '\rundll32.exe'
  condition: selection_parent and selection_child
level: high

```

8.3. Network Hunt Query

```

DeviceNetworkEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(14d)
| where InitiatingProcessFileName in~
('powershell.exe', 'cmd.exe', 'wscript.exe', 'cscript.exe', 'rundll32.exe', 'python.exe', 'node.exe')
| summarize Connections=count(), RemoteIPs=dcount(RemoteIP), RemoteUrls=make_set(RemoteUrl, 20) by
DeviceName, InitiatingProcessFileName, InitiatingProcessCommandLine
| order by Connections desc

```

9. Threat Hunting

9.1. Hunt Hypotheses

Hypothesis	Query Focus
A user or administrator was socially engineered into executing attacker tooling.	Script interpreters spawned from collaboration, browser, or email processes.
A vulnerable public-facing service was exploited and used for staging.	Web-service parent processes launching shells or making rare outbound connections.
Stolen or purchased credentials enabled follow-on access.	New device, new geography, or abnormal application access in identity logs.

9.2. Endpoint Query

```

DeviceProcessEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(14d)
| where FileName in~
('powershell.exe', 'cmd.exe', 'wscript.exe', 'cscript.exe', 'mshta.exe', 'rundll32.exe', 'node.exe', 'python.exe')
| where ProcessCommandLine has_any ('download', 'invoke-webrequest', 'frombase64string', '-enc', 'curl', 'wget', 'token', 'apikey')
| project Timestamp, DeviceName, InitiatingProcessFileName, FileName, ProcessCommandLine, AccountName
| order by Timestamp desc

```

9.3. Identity Query

```

SigninLogs
| where TimeGenerated > ago(14d)
| summarize Apps=make_set(AppDisplayName, 20), IPs=make_set(IPAddress, 50),
Countries=make_set(Location, 20), Count=count() by UserPrincipalName
| where array_length(IPs) > 5 or array_length(Countries) > 2 or Count > 50

```

10. MITRE ATT&CK Mapping

Technique	Name	Evidence / Rationale
T1190	Exploit Public-Facing Application	PaperCut web application exploitation.
T1059	Command and Scripting Interpreter	Web service spawning shells or scripts.
T1003	OS Credential Dumping	Plausible follow-on from privileged

		Windows print servers.
T1078	Valid Accounts	Domain-integrated servers can enable account abuse.

11. Risk Assessment

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Notes
Internet-exposed PaperCut	High	High	Campaign reporting indicates mass exploitation.
Domain escalation	Medium	High	Depends on service account and segmentation posture.
Detection lag	Medium	Medium	Automated campaigns can move faster than manual triage.

12. Recommended Actions

Priority	Owner	Action
1	SOC / detection engineering	Deploy or tune detections above and run the 14-day hunts.
2	Vulnerability / IT operations	Patch or isolate exposed systems named in the source coverage.
3	Identity / endpoint engineering	Review MFA, device compliance, and suspicious remote-tool execution.
4	Third-party risk	Confirm suppliers and managed-service providers are applying equivalent controls.

13. References

- [1] GreyNoise: <https://www.greynoise.io/blog/ai-orchestrated-campaign-against-papercut-ng-mf>
- [2] The Hacker News: <https://thehackernews.com/2026/09/papercut-attacker-uses-hundreds-of-ai.html>
- [3] Asaf Levy: <https://asaflevy.co/articles/papercut-ai-agent-mass-exploitation/>
- [4] Hendry Adrian: <https://www.hendryadrian.com/ai-agents-exploited-papercut-flaws-to-breach-395-organizations/>